

It's Open Source!

The Open Source nature of the platform is a huge driving force for the wide adoption of the Arduino™. The open source model of development promotes licensing that allows free access to product design files. This allows third-party developers and other users to take the existing code and build on top of existing blueprints. Users and developers help by finding bugs or contributing code to the platform or by writing libraries for specialised hardware or specific functionality such as the Time library we mentioned earlier.

So, if you're good at programming, logic development or coming up with ideas, consider contributing your suggestions on the forum and someone within the Arduino™ community just might turn it into reality.



Knowledge "Open" and "Free" for everyone to access

In conclusion

Thus, we can summarise that the Arduino™ is a microcontroller-based platform backed by a large community of developers that has simplified the way electronic hardware is programmed. We looked at different boards as well as parameters to be considered when choosing a board. We also now know about the difference between hardware and software programming and how Arduino™ has simplified hardware programming by developing libraries. Here's hoping that all this information has piqued your interest enough to want to develop your own libraries! Now let's look at some add-on hardware known better as 'shields'. 